

The Mat(c)hless King!

"I hate Maths, **grumbled** Sanju looking at his grandmother **defiantly**.

"I know," said Grandmother **soothingly**, "but you've got your exams tomorrow, so be a good boy and do those sums."

"I'll do the sums if you tell me a story said Sanju.

"This is **bribery** and corruption," said Grandmother, "but okay."

Then she began.

"Once there was a very proud King who thought no end of himself. He thought that he was the richest, **wisest** and greatest King in the world. One day, a **beggar maid** came to the King's palace.

"Your Majesty, she said, **bowing** before the King, have been educated well by my father before he died but because I am a girl, no one will give me a job worthy of my education. I have come to you to ask for a job.

"Job? **scoffed** the King, for a **slip** of a girl like you? You can get a job as a maidservant in my palace if you want.'

The beggar maid was angry, but she bowed **meekly** before the King. That is not the kind of job that I **seek**. But before I go, won't your Majesty at least grant me one humble wish?"

Ask for anything **your heart desires**, and you shall have it, but within reason, said the King **grandly**.

I only ask that you give me one grain of rice today, and double of that tomorrow, and double of that the next day and **so forth** for a year, said the girl.

That's all? said the **foolish** King before his Prime Minister could stop him. "Your wish is **granted!**"

"Why did you call the King foolish?" asked Sanju.



"Think," said Grandmother, "one grain of rice becomes two the next day, four the next, then eight, then sixteen....

"Then 32, then 64, then 128, then 256, then 512, then 1024, then 2048... said Sanju.

"Then 4096, then 8192, then 16,384 then 32,768, then 65,536 then 1,31,072, then 2,62,144 then 5,24,288...how far can you calculate?" asked. Grandmother.

"Wow Grandmother, you're good in Maths! **exclaimed** Sanju.

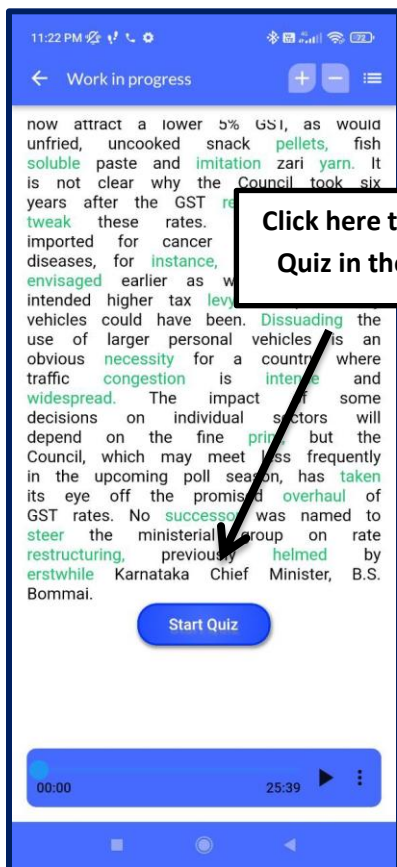
"Well, the King obviously wasn't, for long before the year was out, his **granary** was empty, and he had lost his kingdom to the little beggar maid" "The beggar maid sure knew her Math," said Sanju **admiringly**. "And so should you, if you want to get on in the world," said Grandmother **firmly**, and **pointed at** Sanju's books.

@mocks_wallah

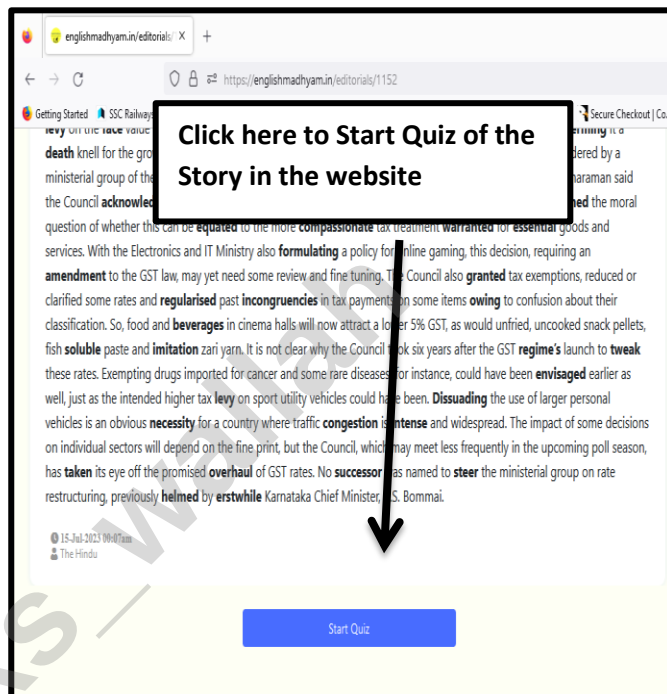
Vocabulary

1. **Grumble** (verb) – complain, mutter, whine, gripe, moan – बड़बड़ाना
2. **Defiantly** (adverb) – rebelliously, disobediently, boldly, challengingly, unyieldingly – विद्रोह के अंदाज़ में
3. **Soothingly** (adverb) – calmly, gently, reassuringly, comfortingly, pacifyingly – शांतिपूर्वक / सांत्वना देते हुए
4. **Bribery** (noun) – corruption, graft, inducement, payoff, subornation – रिश्वतखोरी
5. **Wise** (adjective) – intelligent, sensible, prudent, knowledgeable, clever – बुद्धिमान
6. **Beggar** (noun) – pauper, mendicant, vagrant, panhandler, homeless – भिखारी
7. **Maid** (noun) – servant, housekeeper, domestic help, cleaning lady, attendant – नौकरानी
8. **Bow** (verb) – bend, stoop, kneel, incline, curtsy – झुकना / सिर झुकाना
9. **Scoff** (verb) – mock, sneer, jeer, ridicule, deride – उपहास करना
10. **A slip of something** (phrase) – a small or young example, slight thing, wisp, little one, youngster – नाज़ुक या छोटी सी चीज़/व्यक्ति
11. **Meekly** (adverb) – humbly, submissively, gently, quietly, obediently – विनम्रता से
12. **Seek** (verb) – search for, look for, request, ask, pursue – मांग करना / खोजना
13. **One's heart desires** (phrase) – wish for, long for, aspire to, crave, want deeply – जिसकी दिल से इच्छा हो
14. **Grandly** (adverb) – magnificently, nobly, pompously, splendidly, showily – भव्यता से / शान से
15. **So forth** (phrase) – and so on, etcetera, and the like, and so on and so forth, and similar things – वगैरह
16. **Foolish** (adjective) – unwise, silly, naive, thoughtless, imprudent – मूर्खतापूर्ण
17. **Grant** (verb) – give, bestow, allow, award, permit – देना / प्रदान करना
18. **Exclaim** (verb) – shout, cry out, call out, proclaim, blurt – चिल्लाना / उत्साह से बोलना
19. **Granary** (noun) – storehouse, silo, barn, grain storage, depot – अन्न भंडार
20. **Admiringly** (adverb) – appreciatively, approvingly, with praise, respectfully, in awe – प्रशंसा करते हुए
21. **Firmly** (adverb) – resolutely, strictly, strongly, sternly, confidently – दृढ़ता से
22. **Point at** (phrasal verb) – indicate, gesture toward, show, direct attention, refer to – की ओर इशारा करना

Practice Exercise



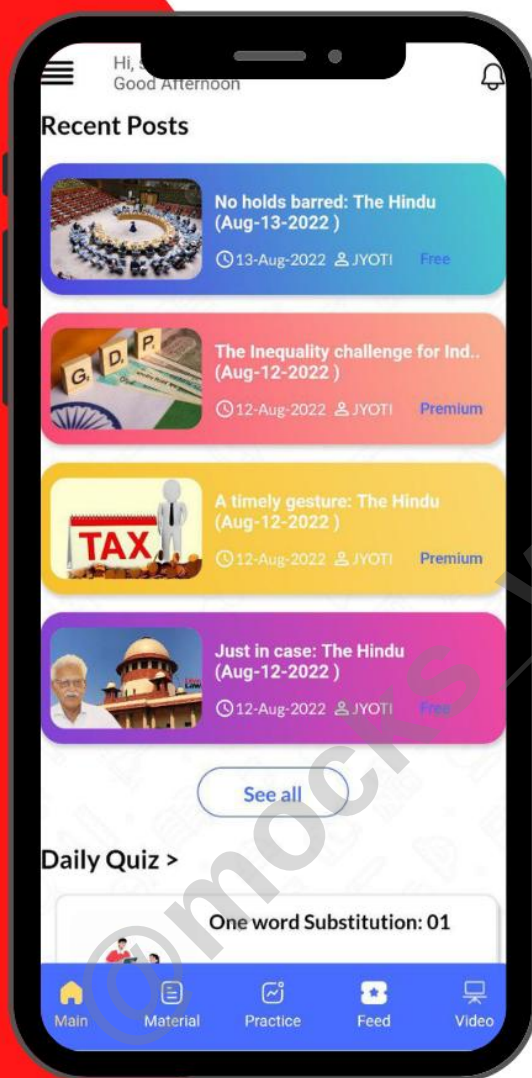
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